

Avery Chahl

The Pennsylvania State University | Department of Human Development and Family Studies
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Education

The Pennsylvania State University <i>Ph. D. Student (Candidate, ABD)</i> Human Development and Family Studies Supervisors: Jennifer L. Maggs, Ph.D., & Kelly L. Rulison, Ph.D. Thesis: <i>Perceived peer norms and adolescent religious attitudes: Insights from the Kingdom of Bahrain.</i>	Expected 2027
The Pennsylvania State University <i>Master of Science</i> Human Development and Family Studies Certificate in Translational Science Thesis: <i>Examining the association between school connectedness and use of self-regulation strategies in middle childhood</i>	2022
The University of Texas at Austin <i>Bachelor of Arts</i> Psychology with Special Honors Minor in Health Communications Thesis: <i>The Relationship Between Cross-Ethnic Friendships and Psychological Resilience in Adolescence</i>	2020

Visiting Appointments & Fellowships

<i>Visiting Scholar</i> , Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research Kinship Inequalities Research Group, DE PI: Diego Alburez-Gutiérrez, Ph.D.	Oct 2026 – Present
<i>Predoctoral Fellow</i> , The Prevention and Methodology NIDA T32 Training Program, Edna Bennett Pierce Prevention Research Center The Pennsylvania State University, USA	2023 - 2025
<i>Predoctoral Fellow</i> , Bennet Pierce Prevention Research Fellowship in Caring and Compassion, Edna Bennett Pierce Prevention Research Center The Pennsylvania State University, USA	2022 - 2023

Research Interests

Adolescent and child development, radicalization, social norms, peer influence, prevention and intervention science, longitudinal methods

Funding and Honors

Funding

Edward R. and Helen Skade Hintz Graduate Educational Enhancement Fellowship 2023
College of Health and Human Development, The Pennsylvania State University

Bunton-Waller Graduate Assistantship 2020 - 2021
Council of College Multicultural Leadership, The Pennsylvania State University
Awarded to students who exhibit commitment to diversity, equity, inclusion, and justice

Awards

European Association for Research on Adolescence International Summer School 2026
Knoll Endowment Research & Professional Development Funds 2020 -2026
Rapid Research Competition, College of Health and Human Development, 2nd place 2022

Publications

Chahl, A., Bai, S., Rulison, K. L., & Fosco, G. M. (2024). Examining the association between school connectedness and use of self-regulation strategies in middle childhood. *Applied Developmental Science*, 29(2), 161–170.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/10888691.2024.2305343>

Rulison, K. L., **Chahl, A.,** & Hoebe, E. M. (2023). The role of parenting in shaping the friendship context of adolescent substance use. In M. E. Feinberg & D. W. Osgood (Eds.), *Teen friendship networks, development, and risky behavior* (pp. 190–210). Oxford University Press.

Preprints

Chahl, A., Pojman, E. M., & Santos-Lozada, A. R. (n.d.). Evidence of place-based heterogeneity in self-reported health trends among Asians in the United States. SocArXiv, https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/6yh9t_v1.

Chahl, A. (2023, March 19). A Shiny app for teachers to track daily student wellbeing. PsyArXiv, <https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/9r6cb>.

Papers in Progress

Under Review

Chahl, A., Chen, L., Ngigi, K., Rist, J., Wang, D., Linden-Carmichael, A. Exploring adolescent strengths: Lasso regression and latent class analysis for healthy youth development.

In Progress

Chahl, A., Figueroa, C.I., Multi-informant childhood internalizing and externalizing symptoms

and adolescent substance use.

Chahl, A., Coimbra Vieira, C., Age-Stratified Exposure to Alt-Right Content on TikTok's For You Page

Dissertation: Perceived peer norms and adolescent religious attitudes: Insights from the Kingdom of Bahrain.

Chahl, A. Exploring perceived peer norms, religious intolerance, and religious open-mindedness in adolescence [dissertation empirical chapter one]

Chahl, A. Peer norms of religious intolerance and bullying in adolescence [dissertation empirical chapter two]

Chahl, A. The role of gender: Links between peer norms of religious intolerance and physical and relational bullying in adolescence [dissertation empirical chapter three]

Petrie, D. J., **Chahl, A.,** Santos-Lozada, A. Using R to explore interaction effects: a tutorial.

Presentations

Chahl, A.,* (November, 2026). Perceptions of Religious Intolerance in the Peer Group: Implications for Relational and Physical Bullying. Workshop Aggression 2026: Ending Violence as a Global Challenge. [Upcoming Accepted Paper Presentation] Linz, Austria.

Chahl, A.,* Figueroa, C. I. (August, 2026). Multi-informant childhood internalizing & externalizing and later adolescent substance use. European Association for Research in Adolescence. [Upcoming Accepted Paper Presentation] Utrecht, NL.

Chahl, A.* (2024, July). Peer relationships: My present and past work [Invited Talk to Wouter van den Bos' Lab, at the University of Amsterdam]. Amsterdam, Netherlands.

Chahl, A.* (2024, July). Peers' parents versus our own: Parental monitoring and differences in longitudinal drinking behaviors beginning in adolescence [Invited talk at the Netherlands Institute for the Study of Crime and Law Enforcement]. Amsterdam, Netherlands.

Chahl, A., Chen, L., Ngigi, K., Rist, J., Wang, D., Linden-Carmichael, A. (2024, May). Exploring adolescent strengths: lasso regression and latent class analysis for healthy youth development [Presentation in the SPR Cup Competition]. Society for Prevention Research, Washington, D.C.

Chahl, A.,* Bai, S., Rulison, K.L., Fosco, G.M. (2023, April). Coping with academic stress: Considering the complex and interdependent influences of relationships with peers, parents, and teachers [Paper Symposium]. Society for Research on Adolescence, San Diego, CA.

Chahl, A.* Introduction to piloting: A dashboard to track daily student wellbeing (2022, November) [Presentation to elementary school staff during dashboard pilot]

*presenting author

Grant Writing Experience

Chahl, A., Bai, S., & Fosco, G. M. Student wellness dashboard to support social emotional learning in elementary school classrooms (not awarded)
Spencer Foundation

Research Experience

2020 – 2024 Project Coordinator & Graduate Research Assistant

The Pennsylvania State University

Student Wellness Study

PIs: Gregory M. Fosco, Ph.D., Sunhye Bai, Ph.D.

- Coordinated and lead baseline and daily diary data collection efforts
- Primary liaison for school-research partnership as a researcher-to-elementary school liaison
- Developed translational products (i.e., self-coded data feedback dashboard for teachers)
- Managed project data and cleaning, developing codebook

2020 – 2024 Graduate Research Assistant

The Pennsylvania State University

Families Being Supportive Together Study

PI: Sunhye Bai, PhD.

- Ran undergraduate research assistant meetings
- Facilitated undergraduate research assistants' professional development
- Coordinated undergraduate research assistant tasks (i.e., data input, transcriptions)
- Conducted participant baseline interviews

2019 –2020 Undergraduate Research Assistant

The University of Texas at Austin

Biopsychosocial Pathways Linking Discrimination and Adolescent Health

PI: Aprile D. Benner, Ph.D.

2018 Undergraduate Research Assistant

The University of Texas at Austin

Estimating and Understanding Effects of Teaching Teens That People Can Change

PI: David S. Yeager, Ph.D.

Teaching and Mentoring Experience

Graduate Teaching Assistant

HDFS Advanced Child Development	Sp 2026
HDFS Sexual Identity Over the Life Span	Sp 2026
HDFS Internship Preparation	Fa 2025
HDFS Infant and Child Development	Sp 2023
HDFS Introduction to Human Development and Family Studies	Fa 2022

Guest Lectures

<i>Technical Writing</i>	Sp 2025
HDFS Quantitative Skills for Human Services	
<i>Overview of Research Design</i>	Fa 2024
HDFS Empirical Inquiry in Human Development	
<i>Correlational Methods and Regression</i>	Fa 2023
HDFS Empirical Inquiry in Human Development	
<i>Inferential Statistics</i>	Fa 2023
HDFS Lab for Empirical Inquiry in Human Development	
<i>Friendships in Childhood: Social Network Applications</i>	Sp 2023
HDFS Infant and Child Development	
<i>Peers, Cliques, and Crowds- Applications of Social Network Analysis</i>	Fa 2022
HDFS Adolescent Development	

Honors Student Mentorship

Caroline Horn	Fa 2022- Sp 2023
Undergraduate Honors Thesis	
<i>The Home-to-School Connection: Family Cohesion and How it Impacts Connection to School</i>	

Skills and Trainings

Software

Proficient in R, R Studio, Qualtrics
Competent in SAS, SPSS, Mplus, Excel Power Query
Familiar with Python

Methods

Social network analysis
Psychological network analysis (Graphical VAR)
Multilevel modeling (Hierarchical linear modeling)
Bayesian OLS
Other models for intensive longitudinal data analysis

Languages

English (native), Hindi (limited working, 2 years university study),
German (A1 level in progress)

Selected Trainings

Dissertation Summer School (upcoming)	2026
<i>Hosted by the European Association for Research on Adolescence</i>	
Psychological Networks Amsterdam Winter School	2024
<i>Workshop by University of Amsterdam Psychosystems Group</i>	

Professional Affiliations

Developmental Science

- European Association for Research on Adolescence
- Society for Research on Adolescence
- Society for Research in Child Development
 - Society for Research in Child Development Asian Caucus

Prevention Science

- European Society for Prevention Research
- Society for Prevention Research
 - The Early Career Preventionist Network
 - Awards Committee, Webpage Committee

Quantitative Methodology

- International Network for Social Network Analysis

Service

University Service

College of Health and Human Development Graduate Equity Ambassador	2023 - 2025
Departmental Graduate Steering Committee	2024 -
Faculty Meeting Representative	2024 - 2025
Admissions Committee Representative	2023 - 2024
Co-Chair	2022 - 2023
BIPOC Affinity Group Coordinator and Founder	2021 - 2022
Program, Planning, Development, and Evaluation Graduate Representative	2021 - 2022
Newsletter Subcommittee Representative	2021 - 2022

Additional Service

The Pennsylvania State University

Undergraduate Research Exhibition Judge	April 2025
Graduate Research Exhibition Judge	March 2024
Presentation Panel Member	June 2023
Academia Won't Break My Soul: Exploring Refusal and Resistance as We Prepare to Navigate Graduate School	
IMPACT Program Professional Development Program	
Presentation Panel Member	March 2023
Internships and Graduate School	
Hosted by HDFS Undergraduate Student Organization	

Center for the Performing Arts at The Pennsylvania State University

Community Presentation Panel Member

The Frederick Douglass Project

Feb 2022